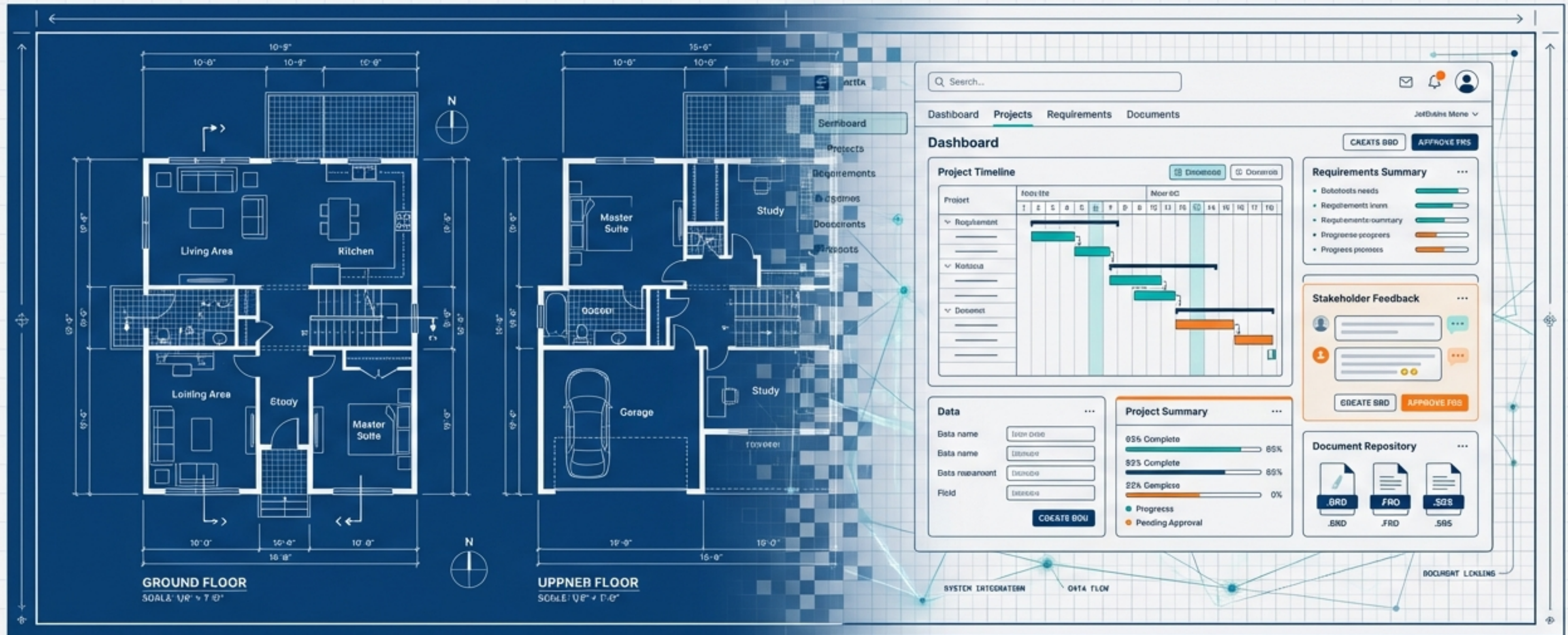


The Blueprint: Decoding Project Documentation

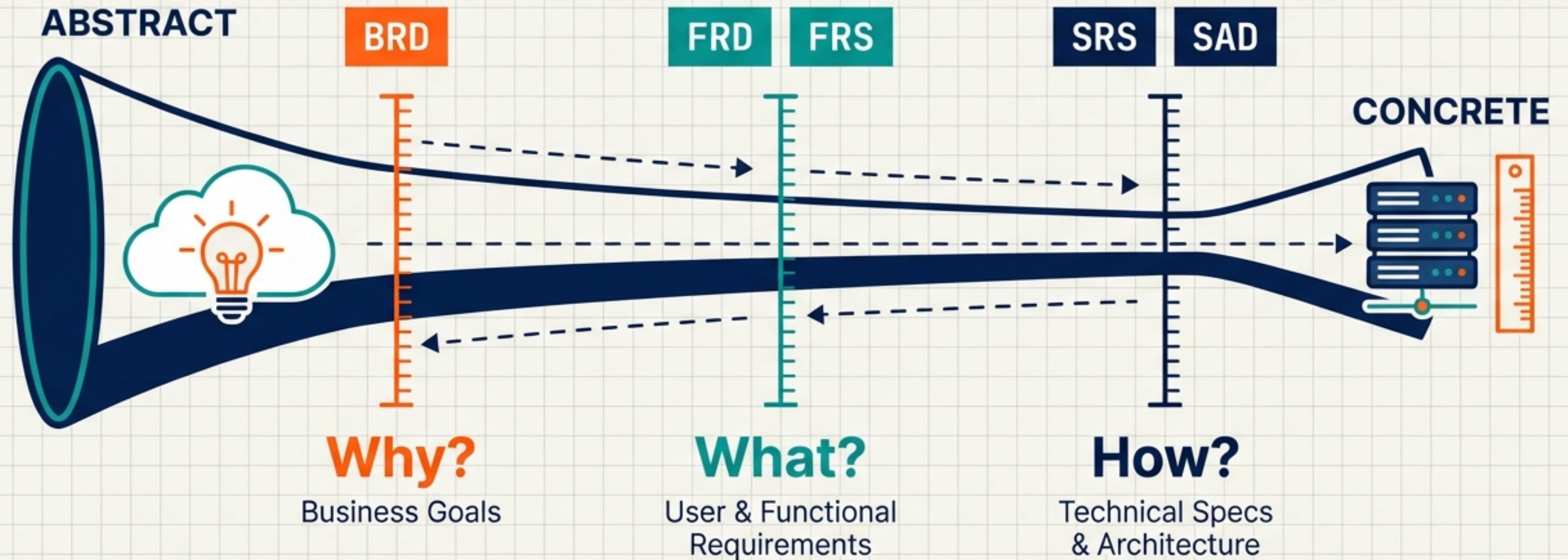
A visual guide to BRD, FRD, FRS, SRS, and SAD for Stakeholders.



FROM THE BOARDROOM TO THE SERVER ROOM

From Abstract Vision to Technical Reality

The Clarity Spectrum



Projects fail when we skip steps. Each document represents a necessary layer of resolution.

The Master Analogy: Building a House

BRD

Why do you want it?

FRD

What rooms does it have?

FRS

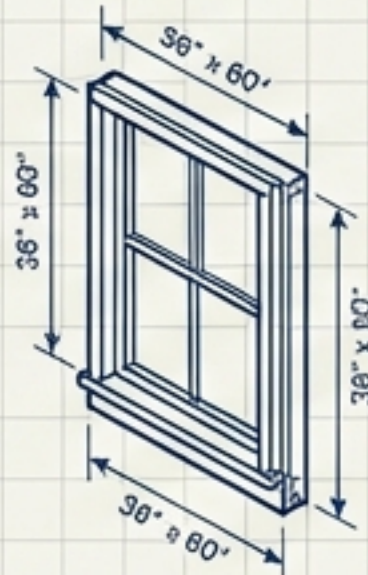
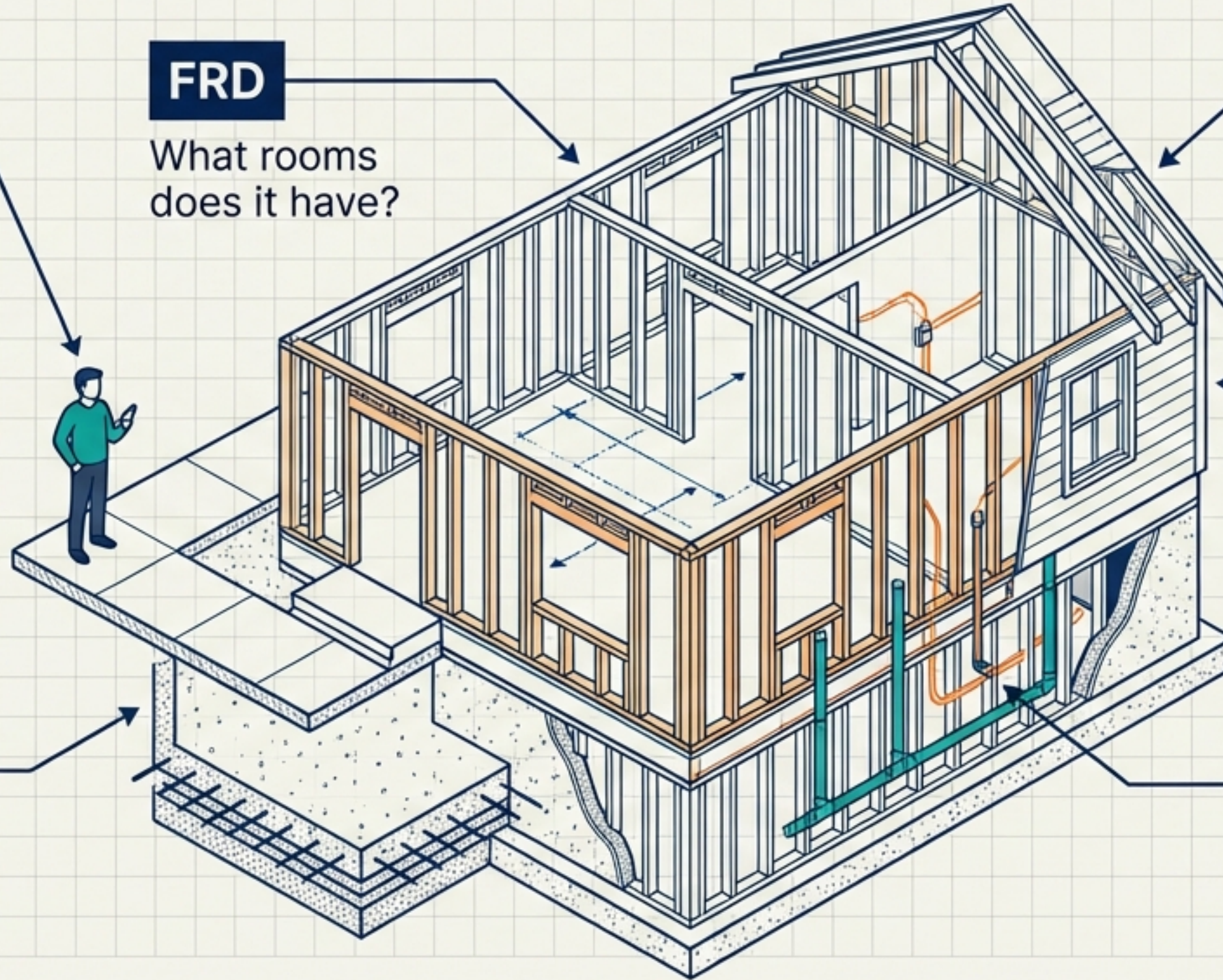
What are the exact measurements?

SRS

What materials & standards?

SAD

How does the plumbing connect?



BRD

The Business Requirement Document

The Vision ('Why are we building this?')

Explains the business problem, goals, pain points, and high-level expectations. No technical jargon.



Audience: Business Users, Sponsors, Project Managers

ZOOM LEVEL: 1/5 [WIDE ANGLE] 



Analogy: My family has grown; renting is too expensive. I need a home.



Real World: Customers need faster delivery; phone ordering is too slow.

FRD

The Functional Requirement Document

The User Experience ("What should the system do?")

Explains functions from a user's point of view. Focuses on features, user actions, business rules, and functional flows.

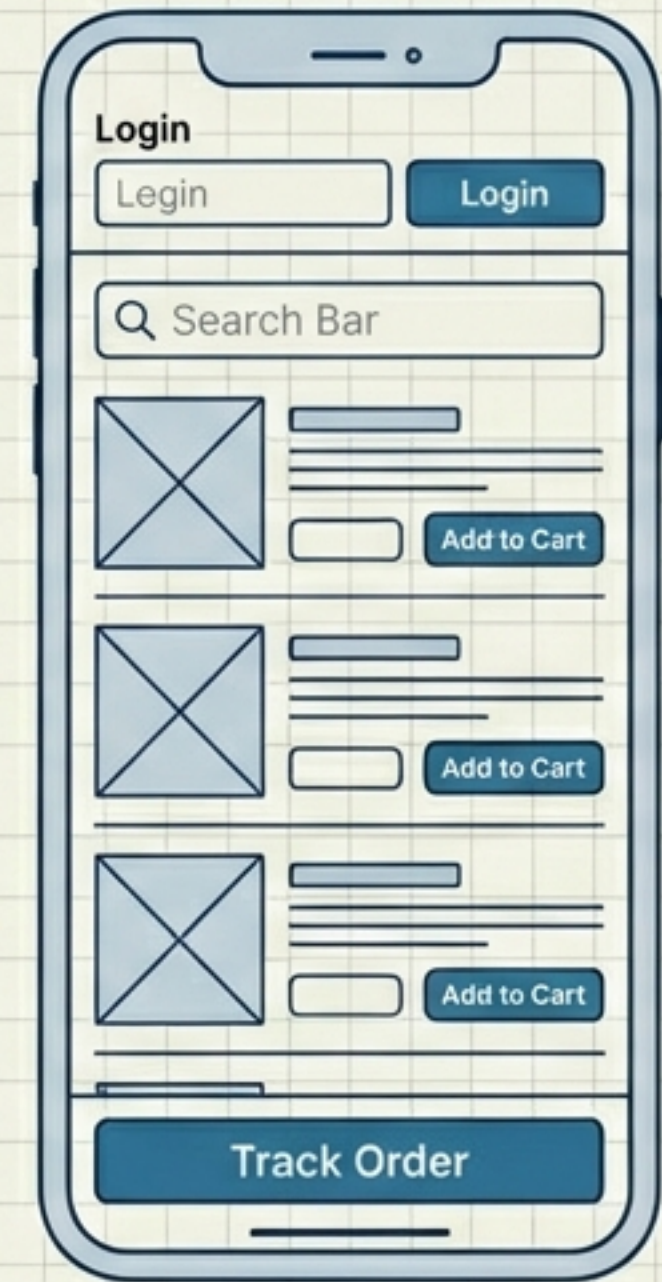


Audience: Business Analysts, Developers, Testers



Analogy: 2 bedrooms, 1 kitchen, parking space.

ZOOM LEVEL: 2/5 [STANDARD]



Real World: User login, Product search, Order placement, Delivery tracking.

FRS

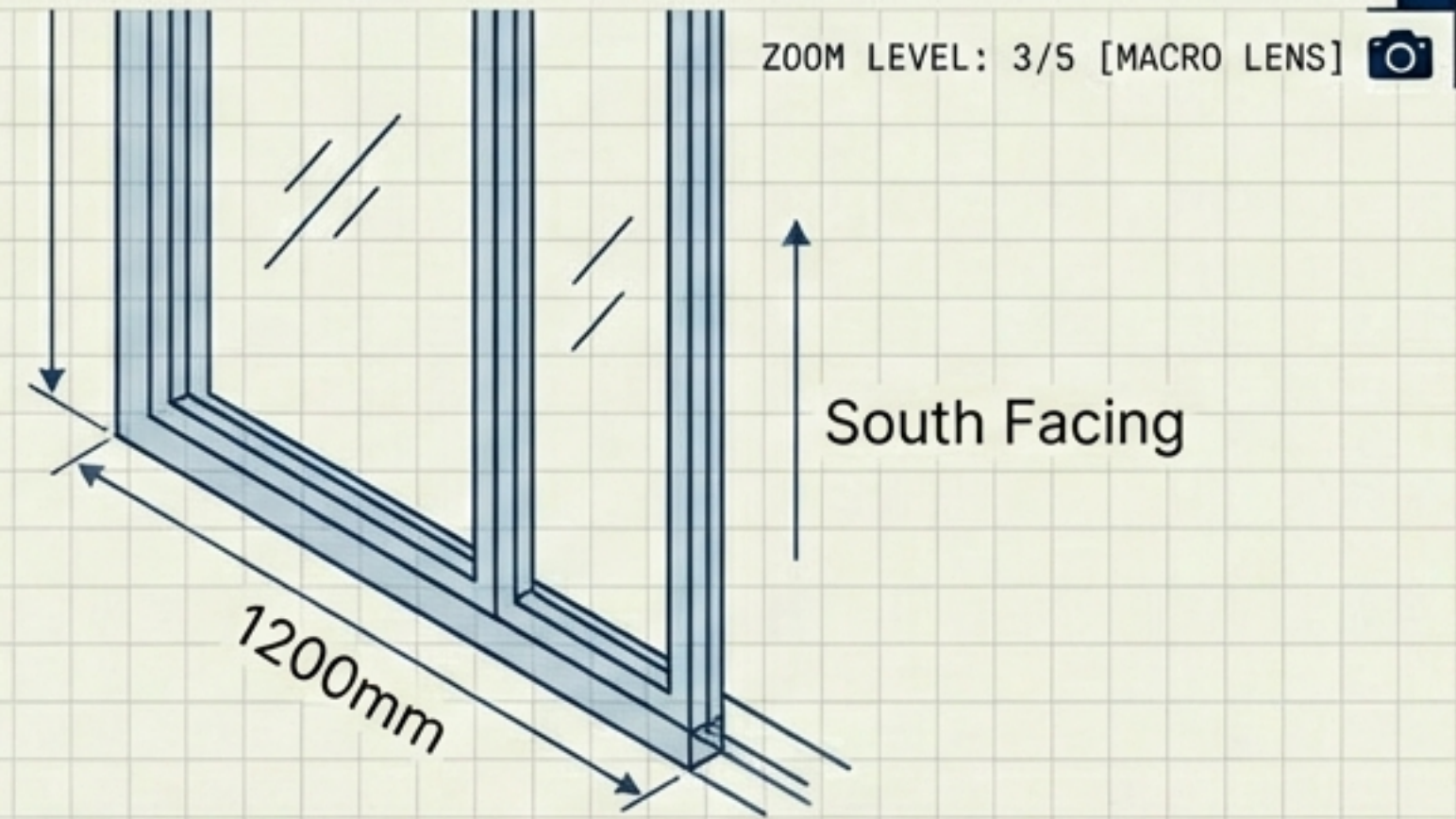
The Functional Requirement Specification

The Specifics ("Exactly how does it behave?")

A detailed, structured version of the FRD. Focuses on input/output rules, validations, error messages, and edge cases.



Audience: QA Teams & Developers (Critical for logic)



Analogy: Master bedroom must be 120 sq ft, two south-facing windows.

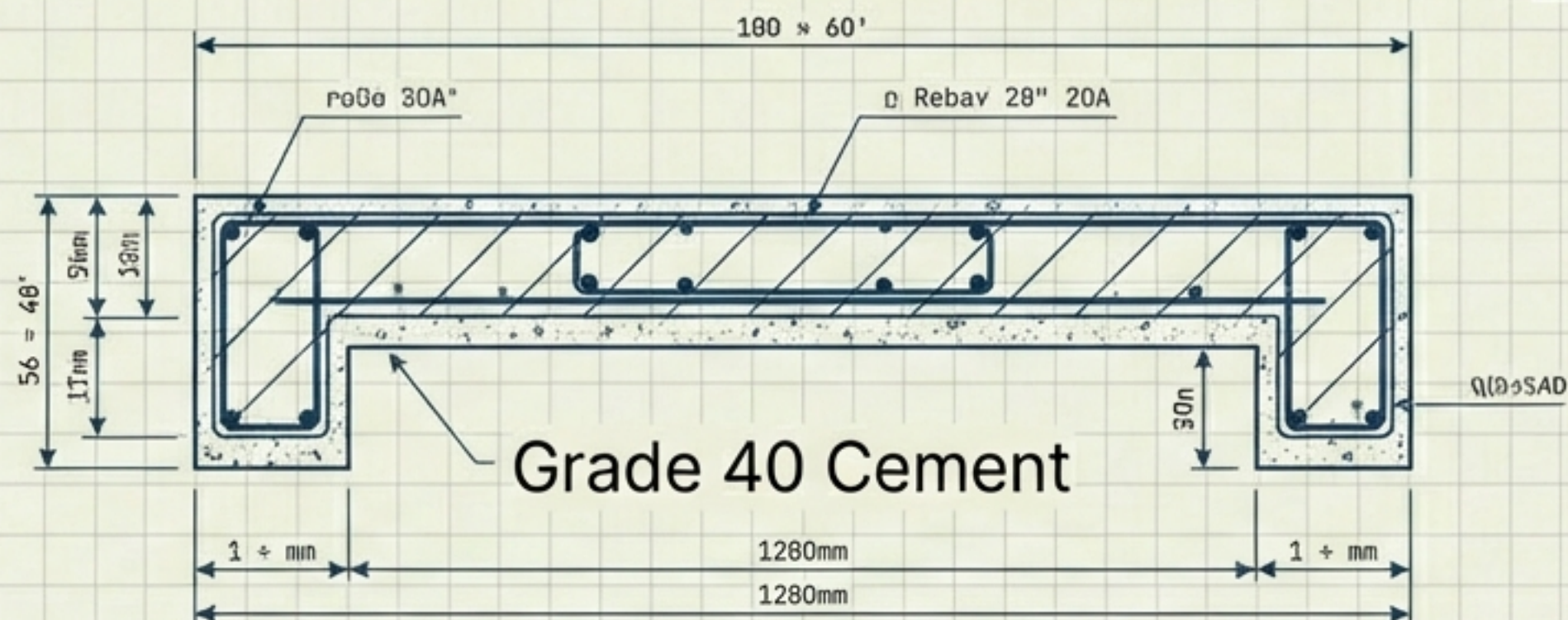
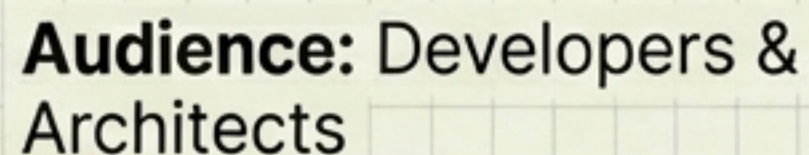


Real World: Password > 8 chars; Account locks after 3 failures.

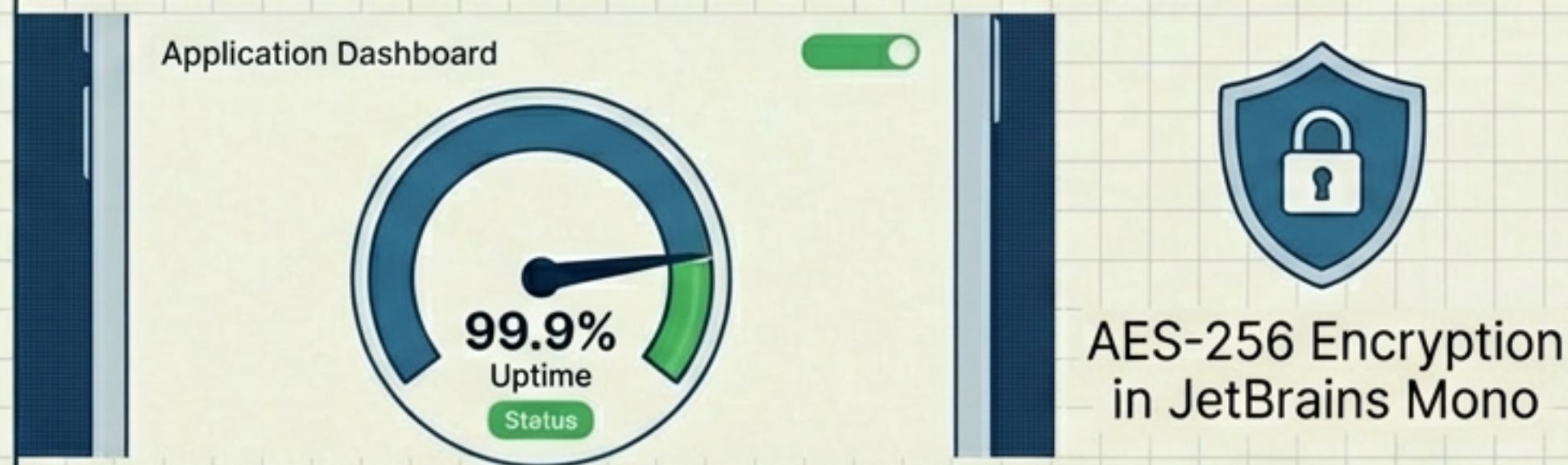
The Software Requirement Specification

The Rules ("The technical blueprint.")

Explains how the software is built.
Focuses on Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs): Performance, Security, Scalability, and Availability.



Analogy: Wiring standards, cement grade, foundation depth.



Real World: Support 10k users, <3 sec load time, data encryption.

SAD

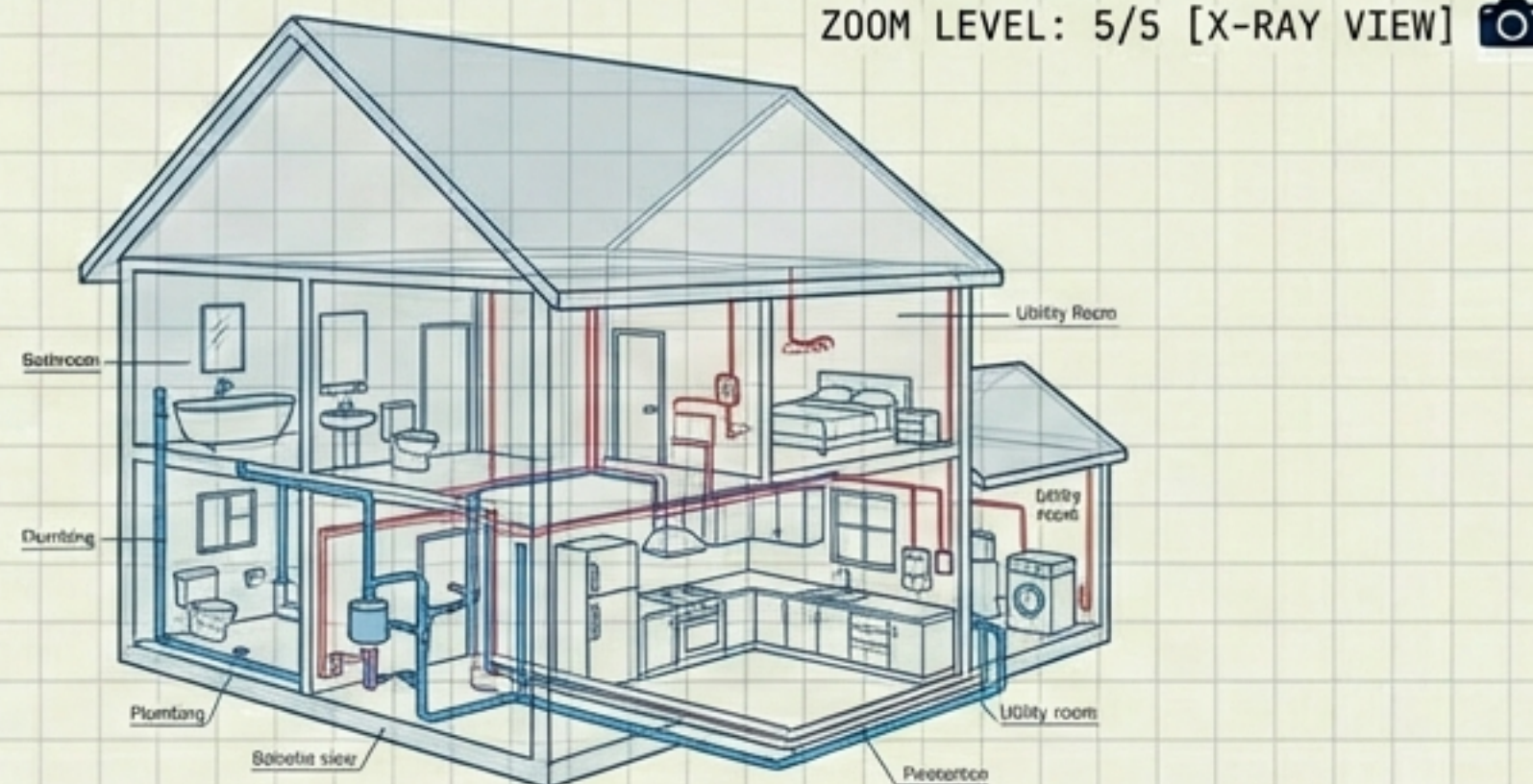
The System Architecture Document

The Structure ("How it all fits together.")

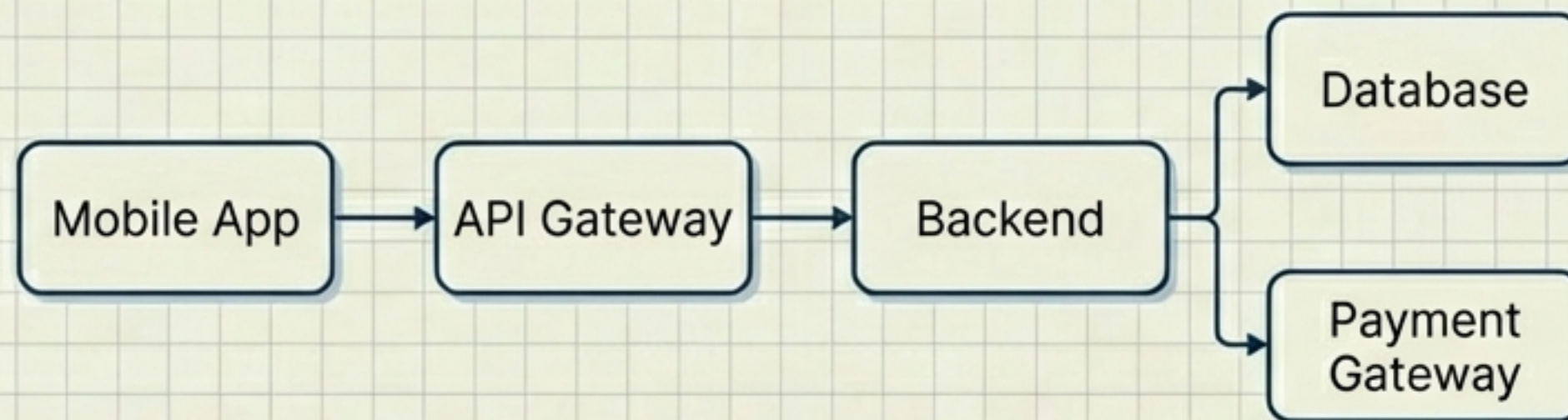
Shows overall system design and component interaction. Focuses on architecture diagrams, tech stack, data flow, and integrations.



Audience: Architects & Senior Devs



Analogy: Electrical wiring diagrams, plumbing layout, HVAC integration.



Real World: App → API → Backend → Database + 3rd Party Integrations.

Clearing the Confusion: FRD vs. FRS

The difference between a Feature and Logic.



FRD

The Feature: "The car must have brakes."

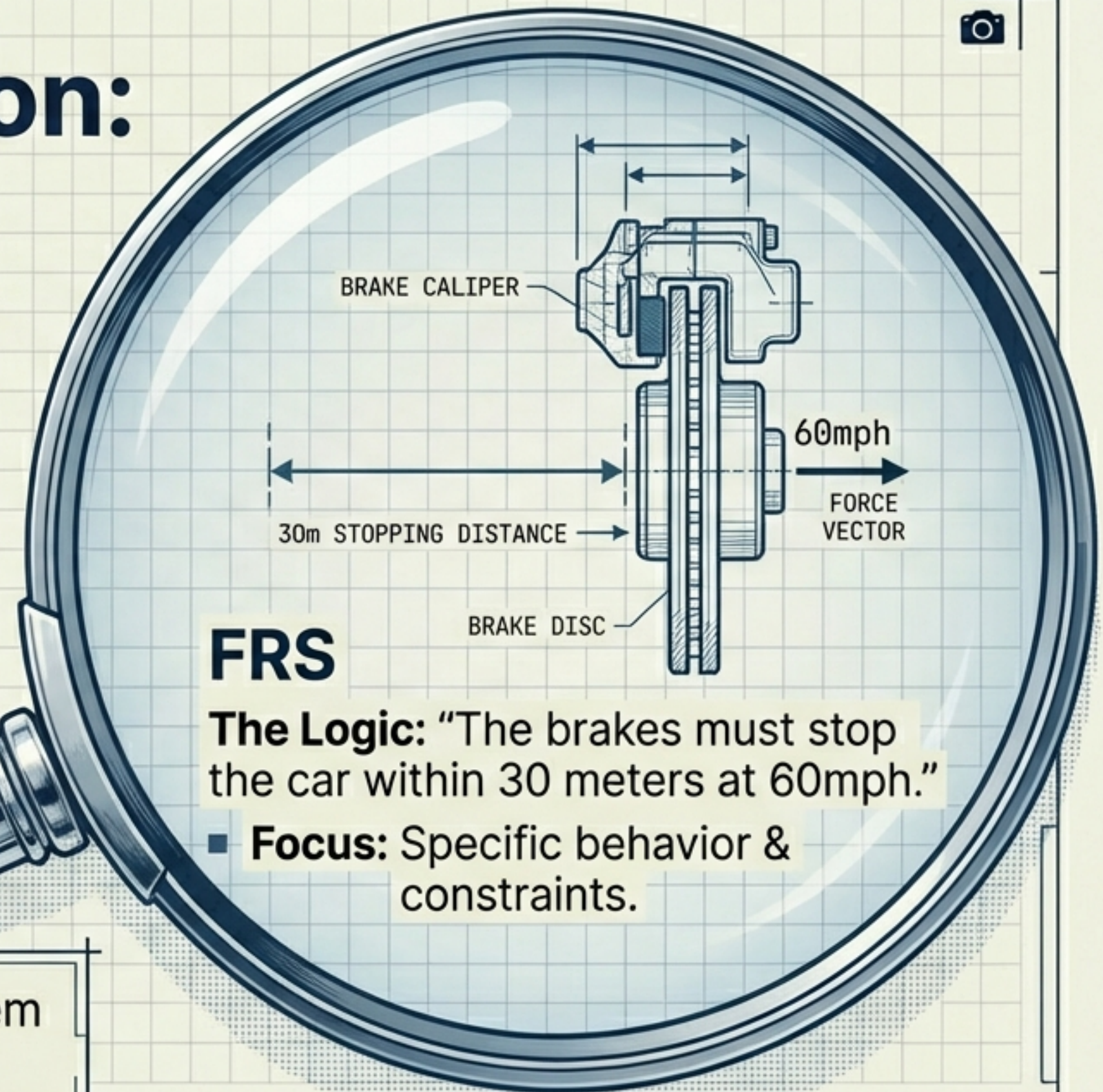
- **Focus:** Existence of function.

FRS

The Logic: "The brakes must stop the car within 30 meters at 60mph."

- **Focus:** Specific behavior & constraints.

FRD tells the developer *what* to build. **FRS** tells them *exactly* how it must behave to pass testing.



At a Glance: The Documentation Matrix

Acronym	Simple Meaning	The Question	Audience
BRD	Business Need	Why?	Business / PM
FRD	System Features	What?	BA / Dev / QA
FRS	Detailed Functions	What Exactly?	Dev / QA
SRS	Software Rules	How (Technical)?	Dev / Architect
SAD	System Design	How (Connects)?	Architect



The Memory Trick

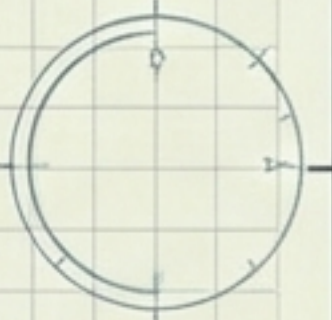
BRD = WHY

FRD = WHAT

FRS = WHAT (Detail)

SRS = HOW (Rules)

SAD = HOW (Architecture)



Great Documentation Builds Great Products



Use the right blueprint for the right stage of construction.